



Origami workshop in progress

to its contentious counterpart — hipster, though only ironically so, of course. Yes, makers like hipsters were always around. They were probably relegated to the corners as hobbyists who enjoyed wood carving or building miniature models of aircraft to scale, men who enjoyed fixing things around the house instead of calling a handyman and craftsmen and women who honed their skills without making too much of a noise about it. Perhaps all it lacked was a formal term, a cool attitude and a rationalisation of how it can impact economies to catapult it to centre stage. It only makes sense that when money is involved, national interests are met, and everything seems a whole lot more important.

There are a number of reasons that this is the right time to be acknowledging the maker culture. Like all wonderful things, it has much to do with the Internet. Post the industrial revolution in the 1800s which represented the transition to new manufacturing processes that made it possible to mass produce, the age of the Internet followed where the masses were suddenly able to communicate openly, in real-time and across geographical boundaries. We turn to Anderson again who construes, “The real revolution here is not in the creation of the technology, but the democratization of the technology. It’s when you basically give it to a huge expanded group of people who come up with new applications, and you harness the ideas and the creativity and the energy of everybody. That’s what really makes a revolution.”